

METHODOLOGY

How the Ranking IS DONE

The INDIA TODAY-Nielsen first-ever survey to rank 50 universities is thoroughly researched and based on the perceptual and factual scores

A team of The Nielsen Company partnered with INDIA TODAY conducted the first-ever survey to determine the top universities in India in humanities, science and commerce streams.

Only those universities which offer post-graduate courses in humanities, science (only pure science) and commerce were included in this survey. Institutions of national importance which specialise only in one area were excluded. To determine the ranks, a formula based on perceptual scores (from an in-depth interview conducted among academic experts) and objective scores (factual data furnished by the universities) was evolved. It was a multi-stage process as detailed below.

Step 1: In-depth interviews were conducted with a few experts across humanities, commerce and science streams to ratify the attributes on which the universities were to be judged in the later stages of the study. The parameters on which the universities were evaluated are reputation of the university, quality of academic input, quality of faculty, research publications/reports/projects, infrastructure, placement opportunities and enrolment for higher education.

Step 2: Desk research was conducted to generate the list of universities for the survey and secondary data sources such as the published reports, the Association for India Universities Handbook and the Internet were used. Suggestions from experts were also included.

A comprehensive list of more than 140 universities was then drawn up using this research.

Step 3: After the initial research, 342 experts—deans, registrars, readers and professors—from different streams across the country were shown the list of 140 universities. They were then asked to rate the universities on identified attributes on the basis of their perceptions. These experts, however, were not

allowed to rate their own university. They were then asked to distribute 100 points across six vital parameters. Each parameter was assigned a weightage based on the average importance given by the experts. Hence the most important parameter got the maximum weightage and the least, the minimum. Each expert was asked to rate universities on the above key parameters for his/her field only, except his own university.

The overall perceptual score of a university was calculated on the basis of the ratings given by the experts on the six key parameters, based on their importance. The universities were then ranked on the basis of their overall perceptual scores. Thus at the end of this exercise, a list of top 50 universities was generated.

Step 4: Factual information from

**342 EXPERTS
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